



Nelson Mandela was among eight men sentenced to life imprisonment during the Rivonia Trial—they left the court with their fists raised in defiance.

THE YEAR BEGAN WITH

INCREASING TENSION between Greek and Turkish Cypriots. In March, the UN sent 7,000 troops into **Cyprus** to try to keep the peace. Strong diplomatic pressure finally brought an end to the violence on August 10.

On May 27, **Jawaharlal Nehru**—the first prime minister of an independent India, and regarded by many as the founder of modern India—died, aged 74. Gathering in mile-long lines, 250,000 men, women, and children filed past his body to pay their respects.

In South Africa, **Nelson Mandela**, a prominent figure of the **antiapartheid** struggle, was jailed for life on June 12. During the trial, Mandela and other members of the **African National Congress** (ANC, see 1994) admitted trying to bring down the government.

Meanwhile, race equality in the US took a positive turn when the **Civil Rights Bill** became law on July 2. The bill created equal rights for all, regardless of race, religion, or color. The signing was witnessed by civil rights activist **Martin Luther King, Jr.**, who had emerged as the symbolic leader of the worldwide struggle for civil rights. At 35, he became the youngest man to receive the **Nobel Peace Prize** for his work.

In Vietnam, the US was adamant that **South Vietnam** should not fall to the communists. On August 7, US president Johnson received approval from Congress to “**take all necessary action**” against the communist regime in North Vietnam. As a result the war escalated, but it was largely kept from the American public, and in November Johnson won a landslide victory (see 1965).

Capturing the American public's attention, the **Warren Report**, investigating the assassination of Kennedy (see 1963) was released on September 28. It asserted that there had been no conspiracy, and concluded that gunman Lee Harvey Oswald had acted alone.

In the East, Nikita **Khrushchev**, leader of the Soviet Union, “retired” in October, having been in power since 1958. His policies had become increasingly unpopular and he was voted out of office.

The Beatles made it big this year, sparking a hysteria known as “Beatlemania.” Appearing on US TV in February, by April their singles occupied all top five spots on the *Billboard* Hot 100 chart.



Beatlemania begins

The Beatles took the US by storm in 1964. Their faces were splashed across newspapers and magazines as their tour of 23 cities sold out.

“ NOTHING IS MORE IMPORTANT THAN INDEPENDENCE AND FREEDOM. ”

Ho Chi Minh, president of North Vietnam, on a propaganda poster during Vietnamese war



Hostile terrain

The US army was technologically superior in Vietnam, but struggled with unfamiliar territory such as the swamp that these marines are wading through.

ON FEBRUARY 18, THE GAMBIA

ACHIEVED INDEPENDENCE from British rule. Dawda Kairaba Jawara became the first prime minister, and was knighted the following year. By contrast, **Southern Rhodesia**, led by prime minister Ian Smith, announced a **Unilateral Declaration of Independence** on November 11. Britain declared this action illegal, and through the UN most countries applied **economic sanctions** against Southern Rhodesia.

In **Vietnam**, the conflict was escalating. President Johnson ordered Operation Rolling Thunder, a massive **bombing campaign against North Vietnam**, and in March the first American ground troops landed in South Vietnam. By June they were fighting alongside South Vietnamese forces against the **Viet Cong**.

Back in the US, racial tension was at boiling point. Following the arrest of a black man for drunk driving, Watts, a suburb of Los Angeles, erupted into violent **race riots**. Some blamed the heat wave, while others pointed the finger at police brutality.

In September **India** launched an **invasion of West Pakistan**,

following covert operations by Pakistan across the ceasefire line. Since the ceasefire line had been established in 1949, both countries had laid claim to **Kashmir**. After three weeks of fighting, they agreed to a **UN ceasefire**.

President **Sukarno of Indonesia** barely survived an attempted coup in November. **General Suharto**, commander of the army's strategic reserve, emerged the victor in the power struggle.

Meanwhile, the lights went out in the US on November 9 during the biggest **blackout** in US history. More than 30 million people in the northwest were left without electricity, which was caused by human error.

